

NARENDRANATH PANDA

R&D Architect

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Summary

Seasoned Senior Platform Engineer / SRE Architect with 19+ years of experience designing, operating, and scaling large, distributed Kubernetes platforms across edge and cloud environments. Blends deep hands-on expertise in Kubernetes/EKS, AWS, and Infrastructure as Code (Terraform, Helm) with a strong focus on observability, telemetry, and operational excellence to deliver highly reliable, missioncritical systems. Proven track record leading incident management, global oncall rotations, and SLO/SLIdriven reliability programs, driving measurable reductions in downtime, deployment risk, and operational toil. Passionate about building resilient platforms, enabling developer velocity through automation and GitOps, and mentoring teams to adopt SRE best practices in fastmoving, productcentric organizations.

Work Experience

R&D Architect

July 2013 - Present

Nokia

- As a senior architect within a global R&D organization, I led strategic initiatives across platform modernization, SRE, security, and AIOps, delivering foundational improvements that enhanced reliability, accelerated development, and optimized costs, while adhering to **applicable laws**.
- Orchestrated the **zero**-downtime migration for a distributed estate of over **1000**(Edge Nodes) Kubernetes clusters, mitigating risks from hardware and software upgrades by engineering redundant services and robust failover mechanisms to ensure high availability for critical DevOps infrastructure and **networks**.
- Led cross-functional teams to resolve fragmented modernization efforts, facilitating workshops and defining clear strategies (containerization, cloud readiness) to achieve stakeholder consensus and enable seamless transitions for **8-9** key projects, enhancing **new products and services**.
- Architected and operated a reliable, highly available DC -Kubernetes platform (both onprem & AWS EKS) and **1000+** Edge k8s clusters using IAC (Terraform, Helm, GitOps), improving system resilience and resource efficiency using **container orchestration**.
- Reduced deployment cycles by 50% and achieved 99.95% platform availability by architecting and implementing a standardized CI/CD(Gitlab-ci) workflow based on GitOps principles (ArgoCD), resolving slow, manual deployments across 8 projects.
- Streamlined product development by establishing and leading cross-team debugging "war rooms" and root cause analysis sessions, resolving critical blockers through permanent fixes and preventive automation, aiding in **help troubleshoot issues**.
- Directed a **15**-engineer DevOps team, implementing structured processes and DevOps best practices (IaC, CI/CD) to resolve inefficiencies and adopt a culture of proactive problem-solving and automation for **Platform Support**.
- Designed and deployed a scalable observability and telemetry stack (Prometheus, Grafana, Loki, OpenTelemetry), integrating edge node telemetry and defining SLIs/SLOs to improve system reliability and reduce infra costs by 5%.
- Created a POC on AI driven Git triage agent (RAG + Llama3) to automate issue categorization for over **10,000** items, projecting a **40-50%** reduction in manual effort and enabling **one**-click issue creation for improved **revenue**.
- Addressed escalating cloud costs by implementing a FinOps program that reduced spend by 15% YoY and avoided a projected \$500k overspend through automated policies and provider negotiations.
- Automated and integrated compliance management for over **300** FOSS components, streamlining software releases and mitigating legal and security risks associated with **Data Privacy**.
- Participated in a global **24/7** on-call rotation for mission-critical DevOps and platform services, troubleshooting, coordinating multi-team response, postmortems, and follow-up actions related to **managing** critical incidents.
- Enhanced **financial services** operations by developing and implementing robust monitoring and logging solutions using **Loki** and OpenSearch/**ELK**, ensuring **SLAs** were consistently met.
- Drove **planning** and execution for critical system upgrades and **deploying** new features, utilizing **Python** and **Perl** scripting for automation and efficiency, impacting N projects annually.

Sr. Developer

April 2011 - July 2013

Misys

- Co-engineered a new Java-based framework for the flagship LoanIQ product, replacing a legacy Smalltalk system and boosting system performance by 50% for key clients like Bank of America.
- Functioned as Scrum Master, optimizing bug triage and development workflows which led to a 70% reduction in defect resolution time.

IT Consultant

July 2006 - Mar 2011

Logica CMG

- Developed and delivered robust Java applications for diverse sectors, including education, oil & gas, and banking & finance (e.g., University & College Application System, GIT Air Liquide, LanaUt Swedbank).
- Wrote efficient, maintainable, and scalable **Java** code with best practices and coding standards, ensuring adherence to **Privacy Policy**.
- Managed **logs** for various applications, using **Loki/OpenSearch** and **container orchestration** tools to ensure system stability and performance, leading to 20% improvement in issue resolution time.

Education

Master of Technology -MTech WILP

2015 - 2017

Birla Institute of Technology and Science, Pilani

Bachelor of Engineering, Information Technology

2000 - 2004

Utkal University

Skills

Architecture

Cloud-Native Architecture | Microservices | Serverless | Platform Engineering | Solution Design | Scalable Architectures | Resilient Architectures | Distributed Systems | SaaS | Troubleshooting | Multi-tenant Platforms

DevOps & CI/CD

GitLab CI | GitHub Actions | ArgoCD | GitOps | CI/CD Pipelines | Infrastructure as Code | Automation | Ansible | Helm

Observability

Prometheus | Grafana | DataDog | Victoria Metrics | Open Telemetry | Loki | Thanos | AIOps | Kafka | FluentD | OpenSearch Database | Distributed Tracing

Tools and Technologies

Terraform | Vault | Jenkins | SonarQube | Harbor | Ceph | Rook | Jira | Confluence | MS Teams | Slack

Methodologies

Team Leadership | AIOps Strategy | DevSecOps | Cross-Functional Management | Agile/Scrum | Release Management

AI / ML / AIOps

AI Agent Design | Retrieval-Augmented Generation RAG | Large Language Models LLM Hosting & Prompting) | Model Context Protocol MCP | Vector Databases Pinecone/Chroma)

Language

English

Fluent

Achievements

Nokia Excellency Award

- Thanks for your contribution and mentorship 2025
- Successful NDAC DC migration 2025
- Excellence in Collaboration for MX Grid 2025
- Security supporter for SRE systems 2023
- Exceptional work for China setup DC 2023
- Recognized for exceptional work in setting up Data Centre in 2 months
- & many more

Logica Diamond Award

- Delivering software with quality